

Fleet Street in 1847 - South Side

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Fleet Street was numbered long before it was at all common to number houses, so it was done in an unusual way – from 1 straight down the South side to 100 and then up the North side from 101 to 183

The street had been divided very long ago into small plots, mostly just 15 feet wide. Small houses had been built, all crammed together on these plots. A great number of people, mostly shopkeepers and artisans occupied these small houses.

This page lists all the people who worked, and often also lived, on the South side of Fleet Street. At number 1, there was a banker next to a hatter next to a lace seller. At 27, there was a painter and glover next to a chemist and then a watch and clockmaker. And at the end of the street was a fishmonger next to a tavern and a maker of boots and shoes.

This gives you a taste of how, in 1847, Fleet Street was crammed with a great number of people living and working in cramped conditions, and engaged in a great variety of trades. At the present day, there are fewer separate buildings, but many of them are very much taller than they were in 1847.